Urinary bladder and urethra

Prof. Dr. Maha Diaa Safwat
Human Anatomy and Embryology Department

Urinary bladder and urethra

ILOs:

1- Describe the normal site, size, shape, position & peritoneal covering of the urinary bladder.

2- Relate the location of urinary bladder and urethra in relevance to the surrounding organs and structures.

3- Enumerate blood supply and innervation of the urinary bladder.

4- Correlate the anatomical features of different parts of the male and female urethra to its clinical importance.

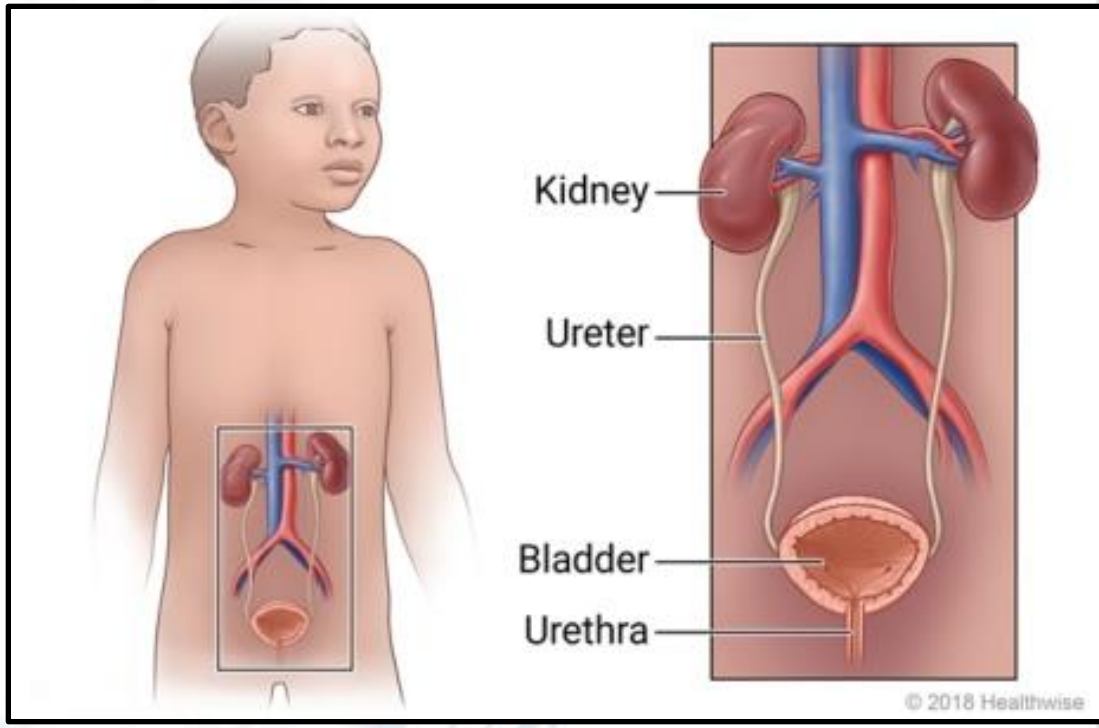
ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Urinary bladder

1- Location and Description:

- The urinary bladder is situated immediately behind the pubic bones within the pelvis. It stores urine. In adults, it has a maximum capacity of about 500 mL.

- Its shape and relations vary according to the amount of urine that it contains. The empty bladder in the adult lies entirely within the pelvis but as the bladder fills; it lies partly in the abdomen.

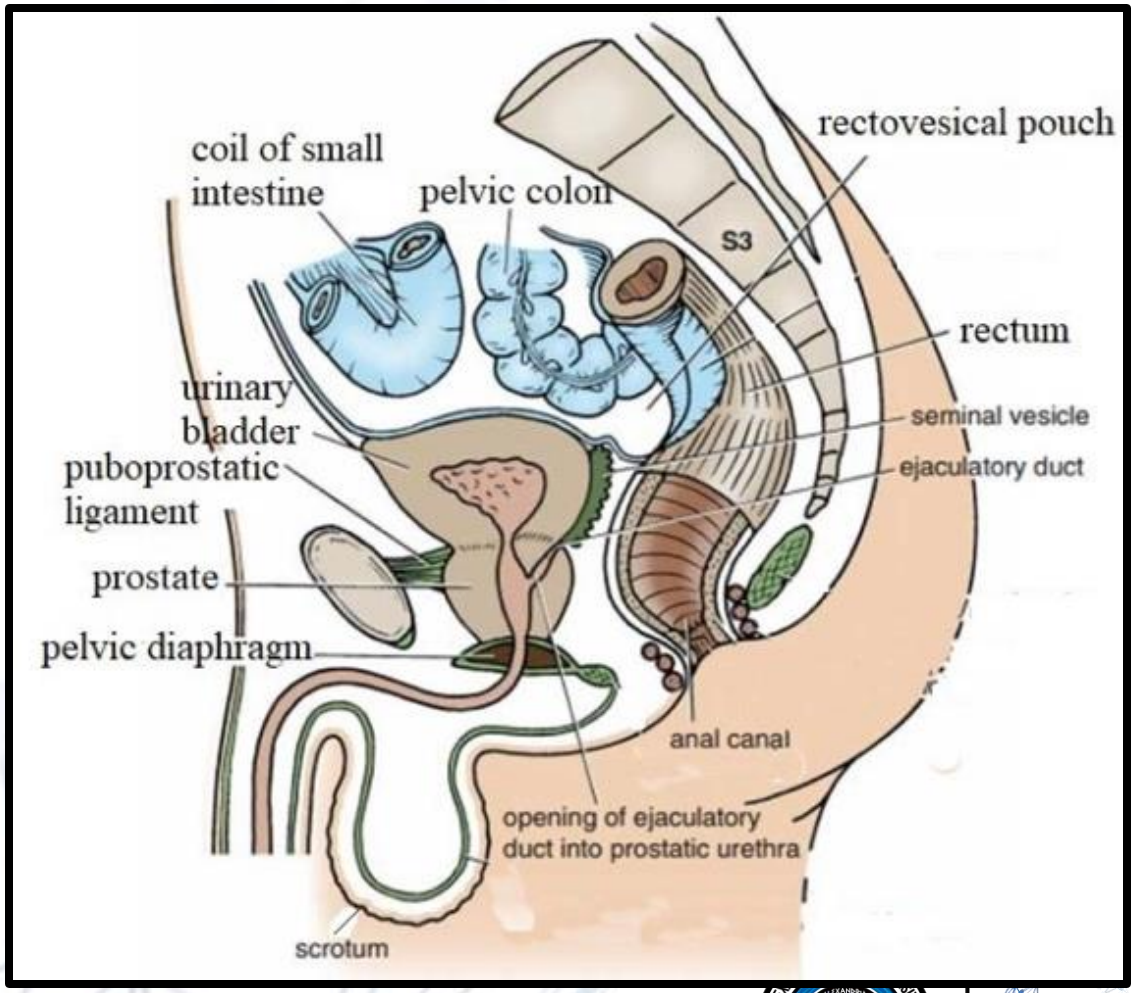


ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Urinary bladder

2- Peritoneal covering :

In male, the peritoneum passes down from anterior abdominal wall covering upper surface of the urinary bladder & upper part of posterior surface. Here, it sweeps backward to reach anterior aspect of the rectum, forming **rectovesical pouch.**

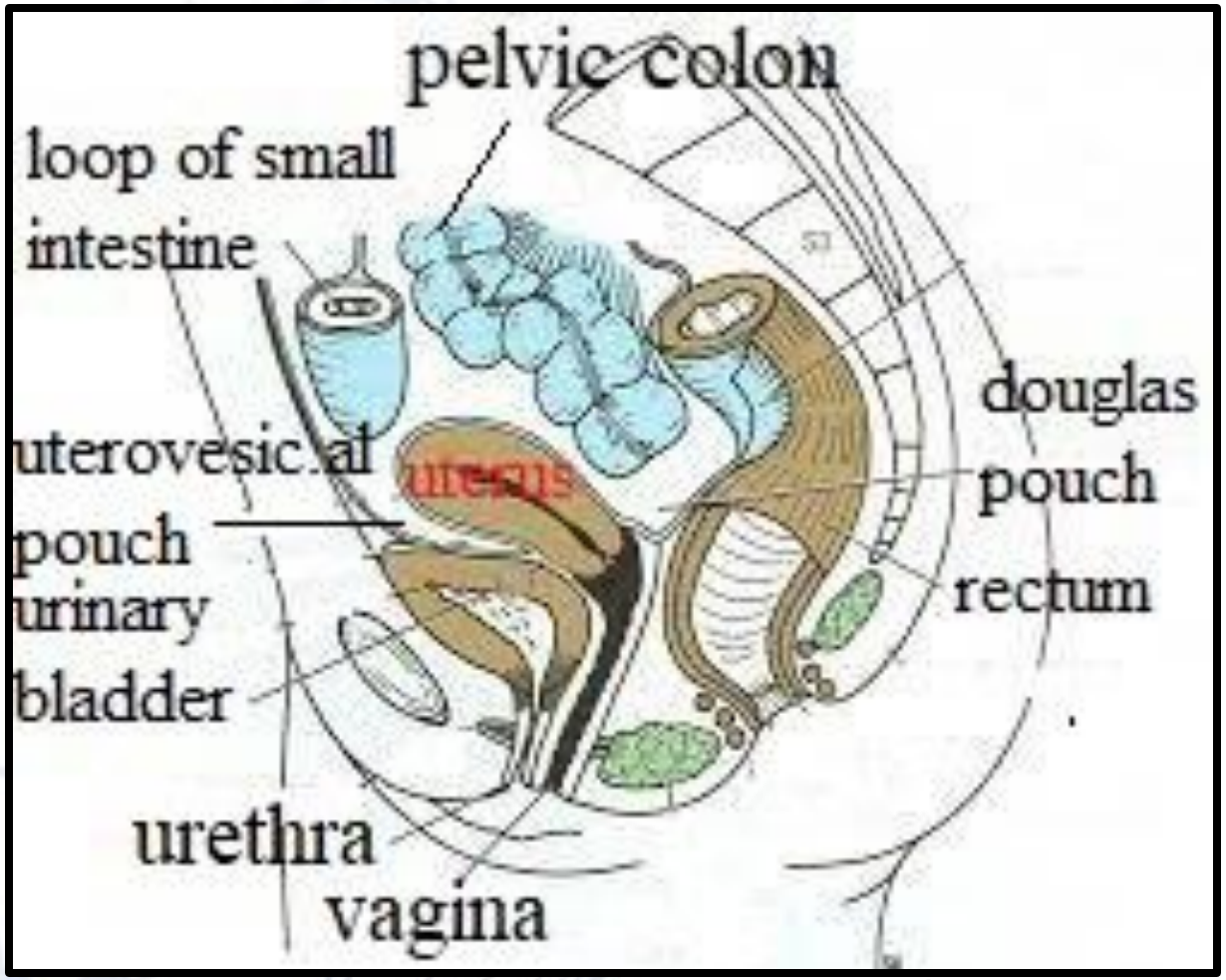


ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Urinary bladder

2- Peritoneal covering :

In female, the peritoneum passes down from the anterior abdominal wall to the upper surface of the urinary bladder. It then runs directly onto the inferior surface of the uterus forming the **utero-vesical pouch**, then it covers the fundus, body of the uterus and the posterior surface of the cervix and continues to cover the upper part of the posterior surface of the vagina to reflect on the rectum forming **rectouterine (Douglas) pouch**.



ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Urinary bladder

3- Shape of the bladder :

The empty bladder is pyramidal, having an apex, a base, a superior and two inferolateral surfaces; it also has a neck (inferior angle) and 2 postero-superior angles.

Apex: points anteriorly and lies behind the upper margin of the symphysis pubis. It is connected to the umbilicus by the median umbilical ligament (Obliterated urachus).

